



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Daily 2026-09-30 Scattered Spider Aviation Targeting and Airline Identity Risk

Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Executive Summary

Aviation-sector warnings around Scattered Spider-style activity and Hawaiian Airlines reporting point to identity-first intrusions, social engineering, help-desk abuse, and SaaS/cloud pivoting as priority risks for airlines and airport service providers.

This report is a daily Lost Boys Cyber automation product for 2026-09-30. It prioritizes defender action over attribution certainty and labels source limitations where public reporting is still developing.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
What should defenders review today?	Airlines, loyalty systems, cloud identity, help desk workflows	Medium
Is there enough public evidence for operational action?	Yes; multiple public sources or source families support risk-based triage, though some technical details remain limited.	Medium
What should be hunted first?	Identity anomalies, exposed service exploitation, suspicious remote-management tooling, and post-compromise staging behavior.	Medium

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
SecurityWeek	Aviation sector warning	Medium-High
CISA Scattered Spider advisory context	Government advisory index	Medium-High
Mandiant/Google social engineering context	Vishing/extortion tradecraft context	Medium-High

Freshness note: this daily selection preferred the last 24-72 hours. When a sector report exceeded that window, it was retained only where aviation/aerospace relevance or defender urgency justified a seven-day or broader context expansion.

4. Threat Activity Overview

The activity centers on airlines, loyalty systems, cloud identity, help desk workflows. Public details do not always include complete IOCs, victim lists, or malware samples; therefore, this report converts available reporting into practical controls, hunts, and review questions rather than overstating attribution.

5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

Exposure Area	Defender Relevance
Internet-facing services	Attackers can enumerate and exploit vulnerable systems at scale.
Identity and help desk workflows	Social engineering, MFA reset abuse, and session/token theft can bypass perimeter controls.

Remote management and supplier access	Legitimate tools can become persistence or staging channels.
Backup and recovery operations	Ransomware/extortion scenarios require rehearsed restoration and degraded-mode procedures.

6. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Sector Dimension	Assessment
Affected segment	Airlines, loyalty systems, cloud identity, help desk workflows
Operational relevance	Disruption can affect passenger processing, flight operations support, engineering workflows, supplier coordination, or connected aircraft/satcom support depending on the environment.
Likely exposure paths	Supplier remote access, SaaS identity, help desk workflows, exposed portals, developer workstations, shared passenger-processing systems, and third-party managed services.
Third-party / supply-chain considerations	Require supplier incident notification, logging retention, segmentation evidence, remote-access control evidence, and manual fallback validation.
Defender actions	Validate crisis communications, fallback processes, privileged identity controls, vendor access reviews, and tabletop scenarios for degraded airport/airline operations.

7. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Exploit Public-Facing Application / Phishing / Valid Accounts	Public reporting emphasizes exposed services, social engineering, or credential abuse depending on item.
Execution	Command and scripting interpreters or mobile/remote-control tooling	Expected follow-on behavior after initial compromise.
Persistence	Remote management tooling, accounts, or web-accessible artifacts	Common in campaigns targeting enterprise services and suppliers.
Impact	Data theft, extortion, operational disruption, or fraud	Reported outcomes vary by case; aviation cases may affect operations even without safety-system compromise.

8. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
See iocs.csv sidecar	Mixed	Only includes indicators explicitly visible in public reporting used by this report.
Remote-management tooling	Tooling class	Hunt for unexpected MeshAgent/MeshCentral, ADB, RMM, or admin-panel behavior.
Supplier and SaaS portals	Exposure class	Monitor identity, OAuth, VPN, and

administrative events.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Suspicious scripting or transfer utilities after web/service access	EDR process telemetry	Find post-exploitation staging.
Unusual supplier, VPN, or SaaS login anomalies	Identity telemetry	Identify social engineering or credential abuse.
Unexpected outbound connections from servers or operator workstations	Network telemetry	Surface C2, RMM, or data staging.

9.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```

title: Daily Threat Review Suspicious Remote Access And Staging
status: experimental
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_tools:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - powershell -enc
      - curl
      - wget
      - msixexec
      - MeshAgent
      - AnyDesk
      - adb.exe
  condition: selection_tools
level: medium

```

9.3. Hunt Query

```

SigninLogs | where TimeGenerated > ago(14d) | where AppDisplayName has_any ("VPN", "ServiceNow", "Okta", "Azure Portal", "M365") | summarize Failed=countif(ResultType != 0), Success=countif(ResultType == 0) by UserPrincipalName, IPAddress, bin(TimeGenerated, 1d)

```

10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If the reported activity is relevant to the environment, defenders should see either exposed-service probing, identity anomalies, suspicious remote-management tooling, or operationally unusual connections in the last 14-30 days.

10.2. Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents | where Timestamp > ago(14d) | where RemoteUrl has_any ("checkin", "boarding", "satcom", "mro", "vpn", "supplier") | summarize count() by DeviceName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP

```

11. Risk Assessment

Factor	Assessment
Likelihood	Medium to High where exposed systems, weak identity controls, or supplier access exist.
Impact	High for organizations whose operations depend on affected

	platforms, mobile banking trust, aviation passenger processing, or third-party support systems.
Confidence	Medium based on public-source corroboration and remaining detail gaps.

12. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC	Run the included hunts and preserve results for incident review.
High	Identity team	Review MFA resets, impossible travel, new OAuth grants, and help-desk escalation workflows.
High	Infrastructure / suppliers	Confirm patch state, external exposure, remote-access allowlists, and supplier incident notifications.
Medium	Resilience lead	Validate backup restore, manual fallback, and crisis-communications procedures.

13. References

- [1] SecurityWeek: <https://www.securityweek.com/hawaiian-airlines-hacked-as-aviation-sector-warned-of-scattered-spider-attacks/>
- [2] CISA Scattered Spider advisory context: <https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/cybersecurity-advisories>
- [3] Mandiant/Google social engineering context: <https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/unc6671-targets-financial-services-and-enterprise-cloud-environments>